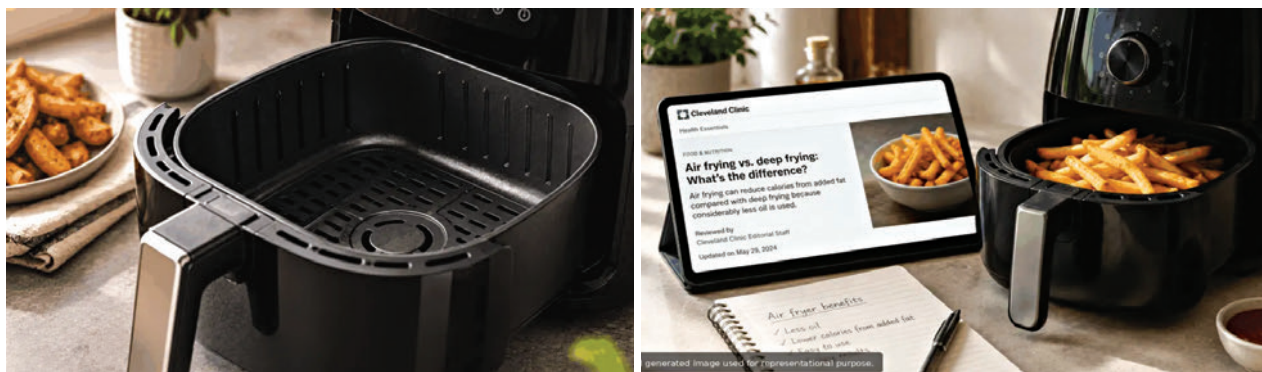




its 7000 Series use ceramic coating. PTFE gets questioned because it belongs to the broader PFAS family. But that doesn't mean a PTFE-coated air fryer is automatically unsafe. Germany's Federal Institute for Risk Assessment says PTFE-coated cookware does not pose a health concern when used as it is intended to be used, while warning against severe overheating.

Therefore, I would suggest you not pick a ceramic-coated air fryer just because the word "ceramic" sounds healthier. I'd first check whether the manufacturer clearly says what coating is being used and what temperature limits apply.

If you specifically want to avoid PTFE or PFAS, look for a product that explicitly says PTFE-free or PFAS-free. Also, don't confuse PFOA-free with PTFE-free, they are not the same thing.

I'd also pay attention to how the coating holds up: If it starts peeling or gets badly scratched, that's when I'd

consider replacing the basket rather than continuing to use it.

What happens when you cook at high temperatures?

It's widely known that air fryers need fairly high temperatures to get food browned and crispy, which brings acrylamide into the picture. The US Food and Drug Administration says acrylamide can form when foods containing certain sugars and the amino acid asparagine are cooked at relatively high temperatures. Potatoes are one of the foods where this is relevant.

But interestingly, air frying doesn't necessarily mean more acrylamide. A 2015 study published in the Journal of Food Science found about 90% less acrylamide in air-fried potatoes than in conventionally deep-fried potatoes under the conditions tested.

The amount of acrylamide still depends on the food, temperature, cooking time and how dark you let it

get. The FDA recommends aiming for a golden-yellow colour rather than heavily browning potatoes.

This is where the appliance's temperature control actually matters. You have more control over how hot and how long you cook the food, instead of simply putting it into a pan of hot oil and then judging the cook on it by eye.

So, is air frying actually healthier?

Compared with deep frying, generally yes. The biggest advantage is that an air fryer can give you a crispy result while using considerably less added oil. That can mean less fat and fewer calories coming from the cooking process.

But I wouldn't take that to mean that everything cooked in an air fryer is healthy. The food itself still matters. Air-fried vegetables are obviously a different proposition from air-fried frozen nuggets or fries, even if both use the same appliance.

For me, the air fryer makes more sense as a different and often less-oily way of cooking, rather than a "healthy food" machine. It lets me skip the pan full of oil, makes small portions easier to cook and still gives me the crispy texture I wanted in the first place.

That's probably the most honest way to look at it: the air fryer can make the cooking method healthier, but it can't make the food healthy by itself. **U**



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